

RAPHAEL MERCHANT

PRODUCTION ASSOCIATE (EVENING SHIFT)

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Creative producer and client lead with 8+ years spanning field production, agency operations, and founder-led client delivery. Specializes in turning complex creative briefs into delivered work — on budget, on schedule, and on brand. Combines hands-on production judgment (drone, video, photo, virtual tour) with calm, organized client communication across regulated and creative environments. Actively uses AI and modern tools (Claude, Notion, Frame.io, Adobe workflows) to tighten planning, research, and delivery.

MOST RELEVANT FOR CLUTCH

- Photo Art Director & Creative Producer — brand, commercial & editorial visual production
- Staged Food Photography — TopPhotoAwards 2021; Toronto's Best Photographers — Snappr 2019
- Led production workflows for ~500 projects/yr across mobile studios (Studio Nostalgia)
- Owned scheduling, call sheets, crew logistics & client approvals across a 400+ km territory (CoStar)

CORE COMPETENCIES

Client Partnership & Trust-Building · Creative Production Planning · Budget & Scope Management · Timeline & Risk Mitigation · Shoot Logistics & Call Sheets · Frame.io / Adobe Workflows · AI-Assisted Planning (Claude, GPT) · Notion / Project Docs · Cross-Functional Coordination · Proposal & Scope Development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE



Founder & Creative Director

2015–Present

akasm (Personal Brand & Studio)

- Founded and lead an independent photography and creative studio — portraiture, editorial, and branded imagery for commercial and editorial clients.
- Deliver end-to-end visual projects (planning → shoot → edit → client presentation), owning production logistics and post independently.
- Manage client relationships, creative direction, and final delivery for a 7+ year independent creative practice.
- Produce photo, video, and motion content for commercial and editorial clients, owning quality and delivery from brief to final asset.



Founder & Product Lead

2025–Present

Bricks — AI Real Estate Media Platform

- Founded Bricks, an AI-powered real estate media platform — product vision, brand, and creative direction modernising visual production workflows, built from firsthand experience producing 14,600+ property listings at CoStar.
- Designed a marketplace-style workflow connecting real estate professionals with photography, video, and visual media services, informed by real-world production and quality-control standards.
- Applied AI-assisted tools and automation to address scalability and consistency challenges observed in high-volume field production.
- Led product storytelling, UX concepts, and digital brand development from concept through execution.



Regional Field Coordinator

2023–2025

CoStar Group

- Drove and canvassed the Greater Golden Horseshoe daily, utilizing various capture methods — drone, LiDAR, video, photography, and virtual-tour capture — to document 20+ commercial properties per day.
- Verified tenants, owners, and building details on the ground — maintaining data accuracy for CoStar's subscribers and shareholders across ~14,600–15,000 listings.
- Served as the primary field contact for brokers, developers, and property managers; supported regional launches (Apartments.com, LoopNet, Homes.com).
- Managed shoot schedules, call sheets, crew logistics, and client approvals — balancing tight deadlines with quality control across a 400+ km territory.
- Owned regional content and data accuracy, flagging quality issues in contributor submissions to raise platform-wide consistency.



Studio Manager / Production Coordinator

2020–2023

Studio Nostalgia

- Led production workflows for ~500 projects annually across mobile studio locations, each staffed with a team of three, managing scheduling, resources, and deliverables.
- Coordinated photographers and production staff across concurrent setups; delivered photo, video, print, digital, and web assets to consistent quality standards.
- Ran studio operations, equipment logistics, and quality control for a mobile, multi-site production model; work appeared for Starbucks, Best Buy, Land Rover, Roots, and Chipotle.
- Supported creative direction and visual development across diverse client projects.



Credit Specialist Supervisor

2018–2020

Royal Bank of Canada

- Supervised a team of credit specialists in a regulated call-centre, coaching performance and reviewing case work.
- Maintained strict confidentiality and accurate case-note documentation on every interaction.
- Delivered compliant, brand-governed information in a highly regulated financial environment.
- Built reporting and governance processes to track exceptions, approvals, and team performance.



General Banking Specialist

2016–2018

Bank of Montreal (BMO)

- Managed client accounts, transactions, and inbound calls in a regulated call-centre setting.
- Built fluency in secure data handling, confidential information management, and compliance-aligned delivery.
- Resolved inquiries with maturity and an upbeat, client-focused demeanour.



Administrative Assistant

2014–2015

Royal LePage Signature — Real Estate Brokerage

- Handled documentation and admin coordination for real estate transactions.
- Coordinated communications between agents, clients, and transaction parties.
- Built foundational knowledge of commercial real estate workflows and terminology.

SELECTED CLIENT EXPERIENCE

Starbucks · Land Rover · Roots · Best Buy · Chipotle · Royal LePage · DoorDash · UberEats

RECOGNITION

Staged Food Photography — TopPhotoAwards, 2021

DRONE OPERATIONS

Advanced RPAS (Drone) Certification — Transport Canada

1,687 flights · 1,580 km · 157 hours logged